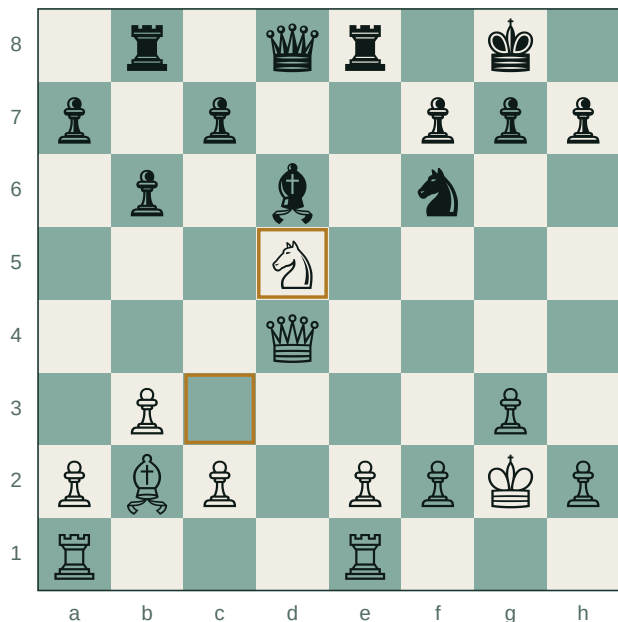


Skewers: Black, move 15

Skewers

Black to move



Previous move: 15.Nd5. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

15...Be5 16. Nxf6+ Qxf6 17. Qc4 Bxb2

15...Be5 The bishop moves from d6 to e5. The changed line means the queen on d8 attacks the knight on d5. Recorded reply: **16.Nxf6+**.

16...Qxf6 The queen captures the knight on f6. Recorded reply: **17.Qc4**.

17...Bxb2 The bishop captures the bishop on b2.

At the end, nominal material is White 26 / Black 28 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, Black's balance changes by +3. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does Black's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +3: the balance goes from -1 to +2. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

The defender may block, capture the attacker, or protect the rear piece while moving the front one. Alignment alone is not enough.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

A skewer puts the more important target in front. When that target moves, a piece behind it may be lost. Checks make the geometry especially forcing.

HOW TO LOOK

Search ranks, files, and diagonals where two enemy pieces line up. Calculate the first target's legal responses.

The defending king is on g2. Look for a defender that can be displaced or overloaded.